I. BASIC INFORMATION:

1. Please note that your **RESEARCH PROPOSAL** is what we consider as **STUDY PROTOCOL** in USC REC
2. Use Times New Roman, size 12
3. Do NOT alter or edit the header of the REC Forms

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Research Protocol Application Form	REC Form No.	27
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

4. A unique ***Protocol Code*** will be assigned to you once the REC staff accepts your application so please **leave this blank**.
5. ***Protocol Title*** is the title of your study. **Please do NOT use ALL CAPS**.
6. ***Name of Researcher(s)/Proponent(s)***
    - Format: First Name Middle Initial Family Name.
    - Use comma (,) to separate multiple researchers, i.e., Juan D. Cruz, Juana S. Santos
7. ***Version number*** should be "***1"*** as this is your initial submission.
8. **NO HARD COPIES ARE REQUIRED**.
9. All documents should be sent through email at **rec@usc.edu.ph**

II. USC REC FORMS AND RESEARCH PROPOSAL

1) USC REC F-26 - Document Receipt Form

- Mark a "✓" under "YES" column if it is part of your submission; "NO" - if it is not
- "NA" – if not applicable

2) COVER LETTER

Please address your letter to the **Panel Chair.** Please refer to the table for the name of the Review Panel Chair based on discipline.

Rejene T. Lakibul, M.P.M.D.	Review Panel 1 (*Management, Education, Political Sciences, Law, Economics, Accountancy*)
Rochelle Marie E. Lerios M.A.	Review Panel 2 (*Engineering, Architecture, Fine Arts, Psychology, SoAn, and other social sciences not mentioned in Panel 1*)
Mae Quenie T. Pontanar, R.Ph., Ph.D.	Review Panel 3 (*Natural Sciences and Health Sciences*)

- The letter should have the official header of your Department/School/Office or Institution
- Date of cover letter should be the date of submission to USC REC
- The letter should contain a brief background of your study and your intention to apply for ethics review. **Please discuss the need for human participants in your study and who your participants are**.
- **The letter should be signed by all researchers**
- **It must also be noted and signed by your research adviser *(if applicable)***.

3) USC REC F-27 - Research Protocol Application Form

- Please fill in all the necessary information on the form
- under *Source of Funds*, please check "**Researcher-funded**" if this is personally funded by the researcher or by their parents.
- Signatures of all the researchers are required

4) USC REC F-28 - Data Privacy Consent Form

- Please read the Data Privacy Consent Form
- Fill in the names of the researcher(s) and the date of signing on the last page.

5) USC REC F-29 - Capsule Proposal

- Completing the Capsule Proposal accurately is essential, as it's the basis for the Review Panel Chair's preliminary assessment to determine if your protocol requires an expedited, full, or exempted review.
- Please do not leave anything blank.
- If an item is not found or applicable to your study, please indicate 'NONE' or 'NA' and provide a brief explanation as to why.
- The signatures and details of both the researchers and the research adviser are required.

6) USC REC F-35 - Protocol Review Assessment Form

- In the shaded area, please provide the page and paragraph number where each assessment point is located.
- Example, for assessment point 1.1. Are the main research questions reasonable? This refers to your Statement of the Problem. If it is found on page 12, paragraph 1, please indicate this on the shaded area
- Please DO NOT mark the columns under REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT
- **All assessment points from 1.01 to 3.10 should be answered.**
- If it is not found or applicable to your manuscript, please write "NA" on the shaded area.

Example under **1. SCIENTIFIC VALIDITY**

1.1. Is/Are the main research question(s) reasonable? *Refers to your Statement of the Problem*

1.2. Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable based on the research instrument(s) presented? *Refers to your discussion of the research instrument(s) used under RESEARCH METHODOLOGY and the research instrument as Appendix.*

1.3. Is/Are the research instrument(s)/data collection tool(s) adopted from existing one(s) and has the developer's consent for its usage in the study?

Refers to your discussion of your research instrument in your RESEARCH METHODOLOGY whether it is adopted, adapted or researcher-developed. Please include the page number of the supporting documents such as email correspondence to the author of the research instrument as Appendix.

1.4. Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies that merit the involvement of human participants? *Refers to your Review of Related Literature.*

Please ensure you thoroughly address the assessment points under *3. Data Protection Plan*. Given that all researches must comply with the Data Privacy Act in the Philippines, reviewers will meticulously evaluate your data protection and management strategies within the methodology. Dedicate at least one to two paragraphs to this critical topic.

Some concerns that you need to address:

1. Where will you save your encoded data? Is it password protected? Who can access your laptop/computer?

2. Are the names of the respondents coded to protect their privacy?

3. How long will you store the soft and hard copies? The reviewer suggests that you keep it for a minimum of three years.

4. As for the hard copies, is the questionnaire coded? Instead of "Name (optional)" in the questionnaire, it should be ***Respondent No.*** as the name is a direct identifier of the respondent. If the respondent agrees to answer your questionnaire, the researcher can assign a unique respondent number for each participant.

5. Where will the hard copies be stored? It should be stored in a cabinet with lock and key that only the researcher and adviser can access.

6. Method of disposal? Hard delete is recommended for the soft copies while it is recommended that the hard copies should be shredded not burned.

7) USC REC F-36 - Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist

- In the shaded area, please provide the page and paragraph number where each assessment point is located.
- Please note that your answers should strictly be based on the page number of your Informed Consent Form
- Example, for assessment point *1.1. Purpose of the study?* This refers to the sub-heading Purpose of the research. If it is found on Appendix A – Informed Consent Form, page 56, paragraph 1, please indicate this on the shaded area.
- Please DO NOT mark the columns under REVIEWER'S ASSESSMENT
- **All assessment points from 1.1 to 1.18 should be answered.**
- If it is not found or applicable to your manuscript, please write "NA" on the shaded area.

8) USC REC F-30 - Detailed Budget Sheet

Sample:

	University of San Carlos Research Ethics Committee		
	Detailed Budget Sheet	REC Form No.	30
		Version No.	09-00
		Effective Date:	08/01/25

Protocol Code:			
Protocol Title:	**Title of the Study**	**Ver.**	**1**
Researcher/ Proponent:	**Juan dela Cruz**		

Particulars	Sources of Funds and Amount (PhP)			
	Personal	External Source* [DOST]	Internal Source*	TOTAL
I. Personnel Services (PS)				
a. Salaries				
b. Honoraria				
Statistician	1,000.00			1,000.00
Sub-total for PS	**1,000.00**			**1,000.00**
II. Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE)				
a. Traveling expenses				
USC to Site A & vice versa (11.00 x 2)	22.00			22.00
USC to Site B & vice versa (11.00 x 2)	22.00			22.00
b. Supplies and materials expenses				
1 ream bond paper		500.00		500.00
Photocopying (12 pages x 120 copies x Php 1.50/copy)		2,160.00		2,160.00
c. Incentive for the respondent				
Token (Php 50.00 x 120 respondents)		6,000.00		6,000.00
d. Ethics Review Fee	1,000.00			1,000.00
Sub-total for MOOE	**1,044.00**	**8,660.00**		**9,704.00**
III. Capital Outlay				
Sub-total for Capital Outlay				
IV. Administrative Cost				
GRAND TOTAL	**2,044.00**	**8,660.00**		**10,704.00**

**External Source – outside your affiliated institution;*
Internal Source – affiliated institution

- You can add rows and items, if needed
- Please indicate the name of the funding source for external grants
- ***No Capital Outlay and Administrative Cost (for undergraduate/graduate studies)***

9) Research Proposal

- The USC REC will only accept and process **APPROVED PROPOSALS**. An approved proposal is one that has incorporated all comments and recommendations from your School/Department's technical panel.
- Please ensure your submission includes the signed **Approval Sheet for the Proposal Hearing** and the signed **Compliance Matrix/Form** *(for graduate and undergraduate students)*.

III. APPENDICES

A. INFORMED CONSENT/ASSENT FORM

- Please note that your respondents will not read your research proposal. It is only in the Informed Consent Form that they will understand your study. That is why it is important that everything should be explicitly stated in the ICF.
- **We require that you use the prescribed templates provided by the USC REC.**
- **Applications not following the prescribed ICF or assent forms will be <u>returned</u> to the applicant**
- Ignore the header and footer of the ICF or assent forms, for now
- **Please submit the sample ICF or assent forms in an editable format as an appendix, not as a screenshot, to facilitate revisions based on reviewer recommendations.**
- The Informed Consent Form has two parts:
    - PART I: INFORMATION SHEET
    - PART II: CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT
- We suggest that you retain the sub-headings found under PART I: INFORMATION SHEET so that the respondents (as well as the reviewer) would be guided accordingly
- What you discussed in your Informed Consent Form should also be discussed explicitly in your manuscript under METHODOLOGY for consistency.
- Your Data management plan in your methodology can be incorporated in your Informed Consent Form to assure the respondents of their confidentiality.
- Under PART II: CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT, please delete the Illiterate section if it does not apply to your target participants
- If your respondents are ordinary household members, we recommend providing a **vernacular version** of your Informed Consent Form. This is crucial, especially if your respondent selection criteria do not require a specific level of English proficiency.

  NOTE: if this is conducted purely online, PART II. CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT **should be the same as the CERTIFICATE OF CONSENT in the online form, i.e.** a tick box if they would participate or not

Please note that the Informed Consent Form is for respondents aged 18 years old and above. If you're dealing with minors, please take note of the following:

If the minor is:	
For minors under 7 years old	**no formal assent, whether verbal or written, is needed as long as there is no manifestation of dissent**
For minors aged 7 to 11 years old	**a verbal assent is acceptable but a documentation of the verbal assent is required**. Documentation may be in the form of a written description of the process and witnessed
For minors aged 12 to 14 years old	he or she shall sign **a simplified Assent Form that is different from the Informed Consent Form which the parents or guardians will sign**.
For minors aged 15 to 17 years old	he or she can sign on the **same informed consent document signed by the parents**
A minor's refusal to participate or continue in the research should be respected. The decision to have an Assent Form for participants below 12 years-old rests on the REC.	

Please clearly separate the assent and consent forms for ease of review.

E.g.

Appendix A – Sample verbal assent for minors aged 7 to 11 years old
Appendix B – Simplified assent form for minors aged 12 to 14 years old
Appendix C – Informed Consent Form for minors aged 15 to 17 years old
Appendix D – Informed Consent Form for respondents of legal age
**Appendix E – Informed Consent Form for parents of minors aged 14 years old and below

***I suggest to separate the Informed Consent Form for parents as the discussion on participant selection and procedures that their children may undergo may be different from the participants of legal age.*

B. RESEARCH INSTRUMENT(S)

- are tools used to collect, measure, and analyze data related to a research topic. They can include surveys, questionnaires, interviews, tests, scales, and observation forms.
- You are required to attach this as appendix to your research proposal
- Please refer to the file: *Guide_Preparing-the-Research-Instrument-Section*

C. SCREENSHOT OF THE ONLINE FORM *(if applicable)*

If administered online:

- Please include a **live link** of the form. Just make sure that the first section of the Online Form should be the Informed Consent Form.
  e.g.

APPENDIX C
Screenshot of the online form
Live link: http://.....

- We suggest that you break down your Google Form into Sections *(Please refer to the file: Proposed Sample Online Google Form v2-24Oct22)*.
- Please provide a complete screenshot of the online form's contents, beginning with the Informed Consent Form section and extending through the entire questionnaire
- The screenshots should be readable by the reviewer

D. OTHER SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

- transmittal letters addressed to the head of the institution or the respondents
- If your research uses an adopted or adapted instrument, you are required to obtain permission from the original author(s), as the instrument is protected by copyright. **Screenshots of such correspondence can be attached as appendix to your manuscript.**
- If the instrument is free to use, you must attach a **screenshot of the official notice as an appendix and provide the webpage's URL.**

E. CURRICULUM VITAE OF RESEARCHERS

- For graduate and undergraduate students, we suggest that you include trainings, seminars attended and previous researches conducted in your CV not just your educational background.
- It must be **signed and dated by the researcher**
- You may include statements like:

  I HEREBY CERTIFY that the information provided in this CV is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

  <signature above printed name and date>

F. CURRICULUM VITAE OF RESEARCH ADVISER

- Please include a list of researches conducted and publications
- it must be **signed and dated by the adviser**

As a summary, we suggest that your application should be in this order:

1. USC REC F-26 - Document Receipt Form *(in word format)*
2. Cover Letter *(in PDF format)*
3. USC REC F-27 - Research Protocol Application Form *(in word format)*
4. USC REC F-28 - Data Privacy Consent Form *(in PDF format)*
5. USC REC F-29 - Capsule Proposal *(in PDF format)*
6. USC REC F-35 - Protocol Review Assessment Form *(in word format)*
7. USC REC F-36 - Informed Consent Form Assessment Checklist *(in word format)*
8. USC REC F-30 - Detailed Budget Sheet *(in PDF format)*
9. Research proposal/manuscript *(in PDF format)*, including the following as appendices:
    a. Appendix A - Informed Consent Form/Assent Form *(if applicable)*;
    b. Appendix B - Research Instrument *(if applicable)*;
    c. Appendix C – screenshot of the online form *(if applicable)*;
    d. Appendix D - Other supporting documents (transmittal letter; letter of request to use the research instrument, approval sheet, etc. *(if applicable)*
    e. Appendix E - CVs of researcher(s); and
    f. Appendix F - CV of adviser *(if applicable)*.

PLEASE DO NOT RENAME THE REC FORMS including the file names.

Please do not send separate files *for the Informed Consent Form, instruments/questionnaires and CVs. Everything must be attached to the research proposal as appendices to avoid confusion.*

We are committed to giving every application the attention it deserves and review all submissions in the order they are received.

Due to a high volume of requests, there may be a delay in our response. To help us maintain an efficient queue, **please do not send follow-up messages on the same email**, as doing so will reset your place in the line and further delay our review.

If you have any questions, please feel free to send an email at rec@usc.edu.ph or call us at 4012300 local 204. Please look for Ms. Emily or JJ.